The Nudge System

How I let AI carry the reminders, the time and the follow ups my brain lets go of.

It is not carelessness. It is how the brain works. So build around it.

Stop relying on remembering.

Time can slip. Memory works differently. Reminders help even for things you care about. None of that is carelessness, so the answer is not trying harder. It is a system that does the remembering for you.

The Nudge System has three parts. A place where every loose thought lands, a clock that tells you the truth, and a follow up that happens without you chasing it. AI does the sorting and the nudging. You do the part only you can do.

What it replaces

Mental lists, sticky notes, promises made in passing and then lost, and the guilt that comes with all of it.

What it needs

One chat that you keep open, your voice or your thumbs, and five minutes in the morning.

Build around the brain you have, not the one the calendar assumes.

Say it out loud, once.

The moment something occurs to you, or someone says "that reminds me", it goes into one place. Not three apps. One conversation.

1 **Name it.** Call the chat Nudge. Pin it where you will see it.

2 **Dump, do not decide.** Voice note or a messy line. Tasks, ideas, promises, worries. No tidying.

3 **Let it sort.** Once a day AI turns the dump into a short list with a day against each item.

SET IT UP (PASTE ONCE)

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This chat is my Nudge inbox. I will send you messy thoughts, tasks
and promises all day. Do not answer each one. When I say "sort", turn
everything since the last sort into: things to do today (maximum
five), things to do this week, things to ask someone else, and things
to drop. Put the date next to anything that has a deadline. Keep each
line to one sentence.
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Five minutes might be twenty.

Time blindness is not a character flaw. So stop guessing and let AI do the arithmetic.

REAL TIME ESTIMATE

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Here is what I plan to do today: [paste]. For each item, give me a
realistic time for someone who tends to underestimate. Double my
guess where it involves other people or switching tasks. Then fit it
into my day between [start] and [end], with a ten minute gap between
items. If it does not fit, tell me what to move.
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Two small habits that help

The ten minute warning. Ask AI to give you the time a task will actually end if you start now. A clear end time is easier to feel than a duration.

The leaving time. For anything with an appointment, ask for the time you need to be walking out the door, not the time it starts.

Nobody has to chase you.

FOLLOW UP DRAFTS

Here are the things I said I would do for other people this week: [paste]. Write a short, warm message for each one that tells them where it stands and when they will get it. Plain words, no apology spiral, under 40 words each.

INTERRUPTED THOUGHTS

I tend to jump in with a related story when someone is talking. Give me a one line way to say "that reminds me of something, can I come back to it?" in a way that sounds friendly, and a way to jot it down so I do not lose it.

BUSY OR BORED?

Someone has gone quiet and I am worried they lost interest. Here is the situation: [describe]. Give me three other likely explanations, and a low pressure message I could send if I still want to check.

Three things, in order.

1 **Today:** paste the setup prompt, then dump everything in your head for two minutes.

2 **Every morning:** say "sort", then run the real time estimate. Five minutes.

3 **Every Friday:** ask what you said yes to and have not touched, and drop or schedule each one.

That is the whole system. It lets you keep the speed and the connection and loses the dropped balls, because something other than your memory is holding them.

Not medical advice. A working routine to adapt: change the words until they sound like you.

Your brain is not the problem. Asking it to be a filing cabinet is.